XU WANG

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EDUCATION

Peking University, HSBC Business School (PHBS) Aug 2024 – Present
Master of Finance *Shenzhen, China*
First-Class Scholarship; admitted through direct admission (top 10% of interviewees).
Coursework: Advanced Microeconomics, Advanced Macroeconomics, Advanced Econometrics.

Peking University, UK Campus Apr 2025 – Jun 2025
Exchange Program *Oxford, UK*

Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (SUFE) Sep 2020 – Jun 2024
B.A. in Economic Statistics *Shanghai, China*
Rank 1/107; GPA 3.76/4.00. National Scholarship; Shanghai Excellent Graduate. IELTS 7.0.
Coursework: Deep Learning, Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing, Multivariate Statistics, Econometrics.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Collusion in the Cards: AI Detection and Explanation with LLMs Feb 2026 – Present
Advisor: Kan Xu, Arizona State University *Remote*

Problem. Online card-game platforms must adjudicate collusion reports case by case: every move can be legal while coordinated intent surfaces only across the sequence. Labels come from 171 volunteer reviewers who disagree on 39% of 8,553 games, and an 84% positive prior makes accuracy uninformative.

Model. Designed VERA, a Qwen2.5-7B architecture that separates evidence from judgment: a rule-grounded analyst (rule-cloze SFT, then distillation on 501 teacher-annotated games) reconstructs each game from the log alone, while the player report bypasses it and enters a trained adjudicator. Proposed reviewer-aware weighted SFT: a cross-attention network over game, report and review embeddings, reviewer histories and vote structure learns a positive weight for each training case.

Results & contribution. On 500 test and 1,000 out-of-sample cases, VERA reaches 0.491 and 0.492 MCC, against 0.343 and 0.245 for a prompted frontier model and 0.424 and 0.420 for the best embedding classifier. Analysis helps only once the adjudicator is task-trained and hurts an untrained one; reviewer weighting gains most out of sample and needs no human review at inference.

Seeing and Hearing the Pitch: Executive Vocal Cues in IPO Roadshows and Underpricing Jul 2026 – Present
Advisor: Kunpeng Zhang, University of Maryland and Yusen Xia, Georgia State University *Remote*

Problem. Beyond fundamentals and prospectus text, does how a chairman sounds in an IPO roadshow shape how new shares are priced?

Model. Built a corpus of STAR Market roadshow videos (2019–2026; 597 firms) with speech recognition and topic segmentation; guided by speech-emotion research, reduced 20 acoustic measures to four interpretable latent factors (valence, intensity, pitch, timbre), checked with PCA and audio-LLM listening tests.

Results & contribution. To our knowledge, the first study to link within-speaker shifts in theory-guided acoustic factors to IPO underpricing. Linear effects are null; the squared pitch shift from opening remarks to substantive content raises underpricing, and valence dampens it (1% level; clustered SEs, year and industry FE, U-test). The effect sits entirely in issue-to-open returns, pointing to information uncertainty over first-day sentiment. Mechanism and identification tests ongoing.

Conditional Random Fields for Sequential Consumer Choice Mar 2024 – Jun 2024
Advisor: Xin Liu, SUFE SUFE Outstanding Graduation Thesis (top 2%) *Shanghai, China*

Problem. Model students' sequential dining choices from objective behavior rather than self-reported satisfaction.

Model. Ran a 14-day panel of 60+ students (539 observations) and fit a linear-chain CRF conditioned on spending.

Results & contribution. 92.7% Acc; stationary distributions rank cafeterias by value and reveal takeout's rising share.

The Convergence of Equity and Efficiency: Evidence from ESG Disclosure Standards Nov 2022 – Dec 2022
Third Prize (top 1.35%), 13th National Undergraduate Economics Annual Conference *Shanghai, China*

Problem. How the GRI and SASB disclosure standards differ in design and in their economic effects on adopting firms.

Model. TF-IWF mining of 160+ standard documents; built a 3,711 firm-year panel from 4,062 ESG reports; DID.
Results & contribution. Contrasted GRI's stakeholder and SASB's financial focus and estimated adoption effects.

PRESENTATIONS (*Collusion in the Cards*)

- INFORMS 10th Workshop on Data Science, San Francisco — Oct 2026
- INFORMS Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), San Francisco — Oct 2026
- Workshop on AI and the Future of Collaborative Innovation (WAICI), NYU Stern — Oct 2026
- NC Analytics and AI Day, INFORMS North Carolina Chapter (poster) — Sep 2026
- PHBS AIEM 2026, Peking University HSBC Business School — 2026

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE & SKILLS

TikTok, ByteDance — Global Marketing Product & Technology — Sep 2025 – Jan 2026
Product Manager Intern (LLM applications) — *Shenzhen, China*

- Turned a vague "marketing intensity" judgment into an annotation taxonomy for undisclosed commercial videos; designed the prompts and, with the algorithm team, distilled a teacher LLM into a lightweight detector (90% precision at 70% recall; language coverage of global traffic from 50% to 99%).
- Built agent workflows for human appeal review, cutting review time from 48 to 2 hours and manual work by 60%.

Skills. Python, PyTorch, LLM fine-tuning (SFT, LoRA, weighted SFT), multi-GPU training (DDP, Slurm), R, SQL, LaTeX.

RESEARCH SUMMARY

I study how AI and human experts should share judgment in platform decisions: LLM pipelines that separate verifiable evidence from the final decision, and that learn from disagreeing reviewers instead of averaging them away. A second line measures what markets learn from how executives sound, turning many raw acoustic signals into theory-guided, interpretable factors. In a PhD, I aim to design and evaluate human–AI decision systems in business and information systems.

REFERENCES

Kunpeng Zhang, Associate Professor of Information Systems
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Yusen Xia, Distinguished Professor; Director, Institute for Insight
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